



Photograph Sandeep Patil

Every month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by 15th of this month.

Beat That!

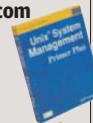
Digit Caption
"Truly 'Mobile' Computing!"

Last Month's Winner!

Neelesh V Saran,
17, Shastri Marg (Elgin Road),
Allahabad (UP) 211001
"Technology is getting
to my head"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win **Unix System Management** by Jeff Horwitz Published by Pearson Education (Singapore) Pte Ltd



researchers believe, might give rise to military surveillance applications.

Picture this: a flock of unmanned aerial vehicles with video cameras could take in a hostile landscape from a variety of angles and process the image locally. Researchers are using lightweight toy helicopters equipped with tiny self-contained computers weighing just 8 grams. The tiny bot, however, has packed enough power to run the Linux 2.6 kernel and communicate over a built-in Bluetooth module.

If things fall into place and all goes according to plan, the helicopters will communicate with one another over Bluetooth, allowing them to move as one entity, and even to carry out sophisticated computation-heavy tasks using distributed computing techniques.

The research team claims that the concept is inspired by the graceful flow of flocking starlings, and the knowledge that the accumulated brain

mass of a flock of 1,000 birds adds up to that of a human brain. By harnessing wireless communications and distributed computing, the scientists believe that they can put a powerful supercomputer in the sky.

However, there is a flip side. Piloting the toy helicopters using software is not easy. Researchers are now working overtime to marry diverse disciplines such as aerodynamics and visual processing to get the swarm up in the sky and keep it there.

TIME FOR A SONG?

Radio Watch

You're in Tokyo but want to know what the weather is like in Frankfurt. How do you do it? Log on to the Internet? No, just switch on the radio!

Epson, in collaboration with Junghans Uhren GmbH of Germany, has succeeded in developing the world's first analogue radio-controlled watch

movement that is capable of receiving signals from three different locations across the globe.

The solar-charged radio-controlled analogue watches available in Japan at present are only capable of receiving standard radio signals from two transmitters in Japan. These watches are unable

to handle different radio frequencies and time codes from other countries, so they cannot receive radio signals from other areas including those outside Japan.

The new radio-controlled watch movement is capable of receiving radio signals transmitted from

